



rather than a list of buzzwords that are hard to interpret or uphold. Once you have chosen your values, you must incorporate them into your business practices and processes. For example, if innovation is one of your values, allow people to take risks and make mistakes without being penalized.

You should also communicate your values to your customers, clients, and suppliers, so they understand your business better, which will help foster more positive relationships.

LIVING YOUR VALUES

In order to instill your culture into the whole of your business, take a holistic approach.

- › **Begin by incorporating** the values into all sections of the business.
- › **Communicate the values** to all those you work with.
- › **Actively demonstrate** what you mean by the values in your dealings with staff, customers, clients, and suppliers.
- › **Adopt values** based on what is achievable now, not in the future.
- › **Avoid meaningless clichés**, such as “There is no ‘I’ in team.”
- › **Use active language**, such as “Do the right thing” (Alphabet, Google’s parent company).
- › **Use your values** to help guide recruitment and decision-making.

Make sure everyone understands

Discuss what each of your chosen values means in practice. How will they benefit customers or clients? How will they help the business succeed? How realistic are they to achieve?

Pick the winning ideas

Place the values in level of importance. Choose the top seven values that reflect the personality and aims of the business. Discuss how to put these values into action.

Incorporate the values

Integrate the values into every aspect of your business, changing practices where necessary. You could add them to your marketing materials, if appropriate.

